ZeitGeist
Moonlit Revelry



Product Pixel

Rulebook 2026

INTRODUCTION

A product is more than an object – it is a story of design, purpose and detail.

This event challenges photographers to translate that story into a single frame using light, composition and visual balance. The focus is not on digital tricks, but on how creatively a product can be presented through the camera itself.

Product Photography is an online creative event conducted as a part of Zeitgeist'26.

TASK

Participants must capture and present a single high-quality product photograph that visually communicates the character, function and appeal of a real physical product.

REGISTRATION RULES

- This is an online individual event under Zeitgeist'26.
- Students from all institutions are eligible to participate.
- Only one entry per participant is allowed
- Each participant' is allowed to photograph only one product.

GUIDELINES

FORMAT

- The product must be a real, physical object arranged and photographed by the participant.
- The product should remain the clear and dominant subject in the frame.
- The photograph must be captured during the event timeline.
- Participants must submit both the original RAW image and the final edited image.

EDITING RULES

- Only global adjustments are permitted, such as exposure correction, contrast, highlights, shadows, white balance, color tuning, sharpness, noise reduction, cropping and straightening.
- Selective or local edits (masking, brushing, subject or background edits, gradient filters, etc.) are not allowed.
- Compositing, background replacement, object removal or addition, sky replacement and AI-generated edits are strictly prohibited.
- The scene, objects and composition must remain unchanged from the original capture.

AUTHENTICITY RULES

- The final edited image must be created strictly from the submitted RAW file.
- Image metadata (EXIF) must remain intact.
- Use of stock images, previously captured photographs or third-party content is not permitted.
- Any inconsistency between the RAW file and the edited image will lead to disqualification.

SUBMISSION RULES

Each participant must submit:

- One RAW file
- One edited image

File naming format:

- ParticipantName_Product_RAW
- ParticipantName_Product_EDITED

Design Specifications: Aspect ratio - Open

Colour scheme: Free choice

File format: RAW in original camera format (DNG / NEF / ARW / CR2, etc.), final image in JPEG or PNG format

- A fixed submission window will be announced for the event.
- Participants may use any camera device (mobile phones, DSLR or mirrorless cameras).

- Entries must be submitted online before the specified deadline.
- Participants may share their final photograph on social media after submission using the official event hashtag.

JUDGING CRITERIA

- Originality of visual idea and presentation.
- Control of light and shadows on the product.
- Composition, framing and styling.
- Overall visual impact and clarity.
- Strict adherence to editing and authenticity rules.

PRIZES WORTH 4K

- Winner - 2000
- First Runner Up - 1000
- Second Runner Up - 750

Participation certificates will be provided to all participants with valid submissions.

PARTICIPATION FEES:

Entry fees: ₹90

CONTACTS

For any queries, feel free to contact:

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NOTE

- Any changes or updates regarding the event will be announced before the submission deadline.
- Any form of rule violation, unfair practices, plagiarism, excessive editing or RAW mismatch will result in immediate disqualification.
- The decision of the organizing committee shall be final and binding.

End